

SOUL WORD ANALYSIS CARD

Framework B — Spirit, Soul and Body Research Programme

Phase 1 Individual Word Analysis

SECTION 1 — WORD IDENTITY

WORD	PRIDE
DATE ANALYSED	04/03/2026
REGISTRY NO.	123 of 181
SOURCE LIST	✓ High Confidence
BIBLICAL PRESENCE	✓ Strong — multiple direct Hebrew and Greek terms; pervasive across genres
POLARITY	✓ Dual-valence — destructive pride (strong negative) and legitimate boasting (positive in Paul's kauchaomai cluster); see Sections 4 and 8

SECTION 2 — LINGUISTIC DATA

Hebrew Terms

NOTE: STEP export included entries for face (aph), physical height (govah/marom), and divine majesty (geut). These have been filtered to retain only verses directly relevant to pride as a soul faculty. Verses about physical stature or divine transcendence are excluded.

Term	Transliteration	Gloss	Key References
גָּאוֹן	ga'on	pride, majesty, arrogance (can be positive or negative)	Pro 16:18; Isa 2:11; Eze 16:49; Amo 6:8; Zep 2:10
גָּאָוָה	ga'avah	pride, haughtiness (almost always negative)	Pro 8:13; Isa 2:11; 16:6; Jer 48:29
גִּיאָה	ge'ah	pride (poetic/rare form)	Pro 8:13
גֵּוָה	gevah	pride (abstract state)	Job 22:29; 33:17; Jer 13:17; Dan 4:37
גֵּי'	ge'	proud (adjective)	Psa 94:2; Pro 15:25; 16:19
גֵּי'ה	ge'eh	proud, haughty (adjective)	Psa 17:10 (implied); Isa 2:12; Pro 16:5
גָּוָה	gavah	to be high, exalted, haughty (verb)	Pro 18:12; 2Ch 32:26; Eze 16:50; Dan 5:20
גָּוְהוּת	gavhut	haughtiness, loftiness	Isa 2:11,17
גֹּוָה	govah	height — used metaphorically for pride (position/heart)	2Ch 32:26; (position heart); Eze 31:10
זָדוֹן	zadon	presumptuousness, insolence, arrogance, pride	Pro 11:2; 13:10; 21:24; Jer 49:16; 50:31; Eze 7:10; Obad 3
זָד	zud	to act presumptuously, deal proudly	Dan 5:20; Deu 17:12; 18:22
שַׁחַצִּים	shachats	pride, fierce arrogance (rare; lion-like)	Job 28:8; 41:34
רוֹהָב	rohav	pride, arrogance (with connotation of hubris)	Psa 87:4; Isa 30:7 (used as title for Egypt)
אָפְהוּ	aph	nose/face — "pride of his face" = haughty expression of his face = haughty countenance)	Egty 4:4 (pride of his face = haughty countenance)

Greek Terms

Term	Transliteration	Gloss	Key References
περὶ φανία	hyperephania	arrogant pride, haughtiness (always negative)	Mega 7:22; Rom 1:30; Luk 1:51 (James/1Pe context)
περὶ φανέω	hyperephaneō	to be arrogant, act proudly	Rare; related to above
τυφίω	tuphoō	to be puffed up, inflated with conceit	1Ti 3:6; 6:4; 2Ti 3:4

φυσί■ω	fusi■■	to inflate, puff up (internal self-inflation)	1Cor 4:6,18–19; 5:2; 8:1; 13:4; Col 2:18
■λαζονε■α	alazoneia	boastfulness, arrogant display (outward)	1Th 2:16; Jas 4:16
κα■χημα	kauch■ma	boast / ground of boasting (neutral to positive)	1Cor 9:15–16; Gal 6:4; Heb 3:6
κα■χησις	kauch■sis	boasting / act of boasting (neutral to positive)	1Cor 13:27; 15:17; 2Cor 1:12; 7:4; 1Th 2:19
καυχ■ομαι	kauchaomai	to boast / take pride (can be positive or negative)	Rom 5:2–8; 1Cor 13:31; 2Cor 10:17; Gal 6:14; Phi 3:3

SECTION 3 — DIMENSION TAGS

Biblical / Theological	✓ Moral ✓ Covenantal ✓ Wisdom ✓ Prophetic ✓ Eschatological NOTE: Pride is the only word in the 181 that is also attributed positively to God (gaon = divine majesty, Exo 15:7) — this dual-referent is theologically unique
Soul Faculty	✓ Volitional (primary — pride as the soul's fundamental orientation toward self-exaltation) ✓ Cognitive (distorted self-assessment) ✓ Affective (self-satisfaction, contempt for others) ✓ Moral-conscience (pride blinds moral perception — Psa 10:4) ✓ Existential (identity-level)
Psychological	✓ Self-concept (inflated self-representation) ✓ Motivation (self-advancement, competition) ✓ Cognition (distorted reality-testing — Obad 3: "pride has deceived you") ✓ Emotion (contempt, arrogance) ✓ Regulation (pride impairs corrective feedback)
Neurological	✓ Prefrontal (distorted self-referential processing — medial PFC) ✓ Reward-pathway (self-aggrandisement activates dopaminergic reward) ✓ Mirror-neuron (contempt for others — reduced empathy activation) ✓ Limbic (threat-response when pride is challenged — anger/aggression)
Physiological	✓ Cardiovascular (elevated arousal in status competition) ✓ Endocrine (testosterone/cortisol in dominance behaviour) ✓ Muscular (erect posture, expanded chest — "high neck", Psa 75:5) ✓ Epigenetic (possible — status-stress dysregulation)
Social / Relational	✓ Self-directed (internal self-elevation) ✓ God-directed (refusal to seek God — Psa 10:4) ✓ Other-directed (contempt, competition, social dominance) ✓ Communal (national pride — Eze 16:49; Amos 6:8)

SECTION 4 — SEMANTIC RANGE

Pride presents the most complex semantic structure encountered so far in this analysis — not because of vocabulary size (shame is larger) but because the same conceptual territory is simultaneously occupied by negative terms (destructive pride) and positive terms (legitimate boasting), and because the primary root gaon (■■■■■■■■) is applied to both God's majesty and human arrogance. This dual-referent structure is theologically significant: pride names both the supreme attribute of God and the supreme sin of humanity. The distinction turns on the object of the exaltation — whether the self is elevated in God's place, or God alone is elevated. The Hebrew negative cluster centres on four overlapping concepts: (1) Gaavah/ga'on — the state of self-elevation, haughtiness of posture and heart; (2) Zaddon — presumptuous pride, the arrogance of the person who acts as if above accountability (Deu 17:12; 18:22 — the presumptuous prophet); (3) Gavah — the dynamic of rising, being lifted up, in a context where that elevation belongs to God alone; (4) Shachats — fierce, lion-like pride (Job 28:8; 41:34) — pride with a predatory quality. The aph ('nose/face') usage in Psa 10:4 is striking — 'in the pride of his face, the wicked does not seek God' — connecting pride directly to the orientation of the face, the biblical seat of relational presence. The Greek negative cluster distinguishes three types: hyperephania (relational arrogance — the vice-list term), tupho■ (internal inflation — 'puffed up', the cognitive distortion), and fusi■■ (Paul's preferred internal term — used seven times in 1 Corinthians alone). The contrast between fusi■■ (inflated self) and agap■ (love that does not fusi■■, 1Cor 13:4) is one of Paul's sharpest anthropological antitheses. The positive boasting cluster (kauchaomai/kauch■ma/kauch■sis) is a Pauline category with no direct OT Hebrew equivalent. Paul redeems the act of boasting by redirecting its object: not in self, not in works, but in Christ (Gal 6:14), in the cross (Gal 6:14), in weakness (2Cor 12:9), and in other people as evidence of God's grace (2Cor 7:4; 1Th 2:19). This constitutes a thoroughgoing transformation of pride's fundamental orientation — the faculty itself is not destroyed but redirected. Pride in the redeemed soul is not eliminated but re-anchored. The Eze 16:49 usage is exegetically important and frequently overlooked: the sin of Sodom is identified as pride (gaon), excess of food, and prosperous ease combined with failure to help the poor — establishing pride as the root disposition from which social injustice flows. This directly connects pride to the social/relational dimension of the 181-word soul anatomy.

SECTION 5 — KEY VERSES

Eight verses selected to cover: pride as soul-orientation, pride as cognitive deception, pride as abomination-generating, pride's destruction, national/communal pride, legitimate boasting, and the divine opposition to pride.

VERSE 1	Proverbs 16:5
Text	"Everyone who is arrogant in heart is an abomination to the Lord; be assured, he will not go unpunished."
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Individual-internal
Human Impact	Arrogance of heart — gaavah as inner disposition — is sufficient to constitute abomination. No external act is required. This is the definitional link between pride and the abomination card: pride of heart is abomination in its generative form.
Direction	✓ Self-directed ✓ God-directed (as divine response)
Observation	CROSS-REFERENCE CONFIRMED with abomination card (Card 1, Section 5, Verse 2). Pro 16:5 was the verse used in the abomination analysis to demonstrate that a single inner disposition constitutes abomination. Pride is now identified as that disposition's root name. Pride → abomination is a direct generative link in Framework B.
VERSE 2	Proverbs 16:18
Text	"Pride goes before destruction, and a haughty spirit before a fall."
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Individual-internal
Human Impact	The most familiar pride text in the OT. Gaon (pride) and gavah (haughty spirit) are paired as cause preceding effect. The soul's elevation of itself is the mechanism that produces its own collapse — pride is self-defeating by its own logic.
Direction	✓ Self-directed ✓ Internally-generated
Observation	This is not merely a social observation but a structural claim about the soul: pride contains the seed of its own destruction. The mechanism is not external punishment but intrinsic self-defeat. Pride distorts reality (see Obad 3), and distorted reality-testing inevitably produces catastrophic misjudgement.
VERSE 3	Obadiah 3
Text	"The pride of your heart has deceived you, you who live in the clefts of the rock, in your lofty dwelling, who say in your heart, 'Who will bring me down to the ground?'"
Context Type	✓ Prophetic ✓ Individual-internal ✓ Cognitive distortion
Human Impact	Pride is named explicitly as a deceiving agent — it operates on the soul's cognitive faculty, producing false security and distorted threat assessment. The self-talk ("who will bring me down?") reveals pride's internal monologue: invulnerability, independence from accountability, self-referential grandiosity.
Direction	✓ Self-directed ✓ God-directed (in opposition — denial of God's reach)
Observation	Pride's primary mechanism is cognitive deception of the self. This maps precisely onto modern research on self-serving bias, illusory superiority, and Dunning-Kruger effects. Importantly, the text says pride deceives — the proud person is not simply wrong but actively prevented from accurate self-perception by the pride-state itself.

VERSE 4	Psalm 10:4
Text	"In the pride of his face the wicked does not seek him; all his thoughts are, 'There is no God.'"
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Individual-internal ✓ Spiritual
Human Impact	Pride (aph — the countenance, the face-orientation) produces functional atheism — not necessarily intellectual denial of God's existence, but the practical orientation of the soul away from seeking God. The face turned upward in pride is turned away from God. "All his thoughts are 'There is no God'" — pride colonises the cognitive faculty.
Direction	✓ God-directed (in opposition) ✓ Self-directed
Observation	Pride is here identified as the soul-state that makes God-seeking impossible. This is a direct Framework B finding: pride occupies the volitional and cognitive space that should be oriented toward God. It is not one sin among many — it is the orientation of the soul away from its primary relational referent. Pride is the anti-worship disposition.
VERSE 5	Ezekiel 16:49
Text	"Behold, this was the guilt of your sister Sodom: she and her daughters had pride, excess of food, and prosperous ease, but did not aid the poor and needy."
Context Type	✓ Prophetic ✓ Communal ✓ Social/Relational
Human Impact	Pride (gaon) is listed as the first and root sin of Sodom — preceding and generating the social failures (hoarding, neglect of the poor) that followed. Pride does not remain internal: it produces structural social injustice. The soul oriented toward self-exaltation cannot simultaneously orient toward the neighbour.
Direction	✓ Self-directed (root) ✓ Other-directed (consequence — neglect)
Observation	This verse establishes the social-ethical trajectory of pride: internal self-elevation produces external neighbour-neglect. It is the relational consequence of the cognitive and volitional deformation identified in Psa 10:4 and Obad 3. Pride → God-neglect → neighbour-neglect is the sequential logic.
VERSE 6	James 4:6 / 1 Peter 5:5
Text	"God opposes the proud but gives grace to the humble." (Both citing Proverbs 3:34)
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Covenantal ✓ Relational
Human Impact	The most theologically definitive NT statement on pride. The word antitassomai (opposes/resists) is a military term — God arrays himself in battle formation against the proud soul. This is not passive disappointment but active divine opposition. The proud soul and God are in a state of structural antagonism.
Direction	✓ God-directed (divine response) ✓ Self-directed (the proud soul's posture)
Observation	The Prov 3:34 citation in both James and 1 Peter signals its foundational importance in NT anthropology. Pride creates a state of divine opposition — the proud soul is not merely unblessed but actively resisted. This is the sharpest possible statement of pride's relational consequence: it places the soul in adversarial relationship with God himself.

VERSE 7	Galatians 6:14
Text	"But far be it from me to boast except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, by which the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world."
Context Type	✓ Covenantal ✓ Individual-internal ✓ Eschatological
Human Impact	Paul deploys the strongest available negative term (kauchaomai) and redirects it entirely. The faculty of pride/boasting is not abolished but re-anchored. The cross becomes the sole legitimate object of exaltation — and boasting in the cross is the inversion of all natural pride, since the cross is the ultimate site of shame (cross-reference: shame card, Heb 12:2).
Direction	✓ God-directed ✓ Self-directed (crucified to the world)
Observation	The redeemed soul's relationship to pride: the faculty is transformed, not eliminated. Kauchaomai redirected to the cross is the precise inversion of hyperephania. This connects directly to the shame card (Heb 12:2 — despising shame) and completes a theological triad: abomination (what God opposes), shame (the soul's self-signal), pride (the soul's deceptive self-elevation) — all three addressed in the cross event.

VERSE 8	1 Corinthians 13:4
Text	"Love is patient and kind; love does not envy or boast; it is not arrogant (fusi■■■)."
Context Type	✓ Covenantal ✓ Relational ✓ Individual-internal
Human Impact	Fusi■■■ (internal inflation, being puffed up) is identified as the direct antithesis of agap■. Pride and love are structurally incompatible soul-orientations: love orients toward the other; pride orients toward the self. They cannot cohabit as dominant soul-dispositions.
Direction	✓ Other-directed (love) ✓ Self-directed (pride)
Observation	This verse is the most precise structural definition of pride's relational dynamic: pride and love are antithetical orientations of the soul. The soul inflated toward itself (fusi■■■) cannot simultaneously expand toward the other (agap■). This is the relational mechanism underlying the Eze 16:49 social-injustice finding: the inward-turned soul cannot see the poor and needy.

SECTION 6 — SOUL FUNCTION IN FRAMEWORK B

Soul Faculty Engaged	<i>Volitional (primary — pride is the soul's fundamental orientation toward self-exaltation and away from God). Cognitive (distorted self-perception — Obad 3). Affective (contempt, self-satisfaction). Moral-conscience (pride blinds — Psa 10:4, the proud soul cannot seek God). Relational (pride as anti-love, anti-worship, anti-neighbour orientation — 1Cor 13:4).</i>
Framework B Contribution	<i>Pride is the root orientation of the unregenerate soul — the volitional posture from which abomination and shame-loss both flow. Where abomination names the moral category that God opposes, and shame names the soul's self-signal of misalignment, pride names the generative soul-disposition that produces both: the inward-curved soul (incurvatus in se, Augustine/Luther) that exalts itself in God's place. It is the foundational misorientation of the soul in Framework B.</i>
Regenerate Expression	<i>The Spirit-transformed soul redirects the boasting-faculty toward Christ (Gal 6:14; 1Cor 1:31). Legitimate kauch■ma is possible: pride in others as fruit of God's grace (2Cor 7:4; 1Th 2:19), boasting in weakness as the site of divine power (2Cor 12:9), and glory in suffering (Rom 5:3). Crucially, the faculty is not abolished but re-anchored. The redeemed soul can honour God's majesty (gaon applied to God) without the distortion of self-gaon.</i>

Unregenerate Expression	<i>The inward-curved soul in its purest form: cognitive deception of the self (Obad 3), functional God-rejection (Psa 10:4), social indifference to the neighbour (Eze 16:49), structural antagonism with God (Jas 4:6), and the generation of abomination (Pro 16:5). Pride is not a surface-level vice but the root misorientation from which the entire moral pathology of the unregenerate soul unfolds.</i>
--------------------------------	--

SECTION 7 — NEUROSCIENCE & PSYCHOLOGY

Brain Regions / Systems	<i>Pride activates the medial prefrontal cortex (self-referential processing, self-evaluation) and the ventral striatum/nucleus accumbens (reward — pride as pleasurable self-appraisal). Narcissistic pride specifically shows reduced activation in the anterior insula (reduced empathy/shame capacity — directly consistent with the shame card findings). Research: Tracy & Robins (2007, Psych Science) distinguish authentic pride (achievement-based, hubristic pride (self-aggrandising — maps onto gaon/zadon distinction). Twenge & Campbell (2009, The Narcissism Epidemic) document cultural escalation of pride-related traits.</i>
Physiological Markers	<i>Postural expansion (erect posture, chest expansion, head tilt — "haughty neck", Psa 75:5; "height of the hill", Jer 49:16). Elevated testosterone in status-competition contexts. Tracy et al. (2010) demonstrated that the pride posture is cross-culturally consistent and recognised even by congenitally blind individuals — suggesting it is not learned but innate. The biblical "high eyes" and "neck stretched" vocabulary maps precisely onto this documented physiological signature.</i>
Psychological Framework	<i>Narcissistic personality (DSM-5): grandiosity, need for admiration, lack of empathy — the pathological endpoint of the pride trajectory. Self-serving bias and illusory superiority (Dunning-Kruger): the cognitive mechanisms underlying Obad 3 ("pride has deceived you"). Terror Management Theory: pride as mortality-denial strategy — self-inflation to counter existential threat. Social Comparison Theory: pride as upward self-positioning relative to others. Hubristic vs. authentic pride (Tracy & Robins): authentic pride (legitimate kauchuma in Paul) is associated with genuine achievement; hubristic pride (hyperephania) with self-aggrandisement and poor outcomes.</i>
Behavioural Signature	<i>Social dominance behaviour: claiming space, speaking over others, dismissing feedback (Pro 13:10 — "by insolence comes nothing but strife"). Reduced help-seeking and learning (Pro 11:2 — "with the humble is wisdom"). Contempt for others as inferior. Vulnerability to catastrophic collapse when the pride-structure is threatened (Pro 16:18 — "pride goes before destruction"). Inability to repent or receive correction (2Ch 32:26 — Hezekiah had to actively humble himself from pride of heart).</i>
Epigenetic Potential	<i>✓ Possible — Dominant social status and its associated stress physiology (elevated testosterone, cortisol dysregulation) have epigenetic correlates. The generational transmission of status-seeking and pride-based social behaviour is plausible via epigenetic pathways, though direct evidence is less established than for shame/trauma. Confidence: Low to Moderate.</i>
Confidence Level	<i>✓ High for pride psychology and social neuroscience. ✓ Moderate for narcissism neuroscience. ✓ Low-Moderate for epigenetic dimension.</i>

SECTION 8 — BIBLICAL vs MODERN PSYCHOLOGY

Biblical Grounding	<i>✓ Direct words exist — multiple terms with fine-grained distinctions. Uniquely, the same root (gaon) covers both divine majesty and human arrogance — no psychological construct captures this dual-referent structure.</i>
---------------------------	--

Modern Construct Gap	<i>Psychology recognises pride as an emotion but not primarily as a sin or a structural misorientation of the soul. The most significant gap: modern psychology has no category equivalent to the "incurvatus in se" — the soul curved inward on itself as a fundamental ontological condition. Psychology treats pride as a trait or emotion to be regulated; scripture treats it as the root misorientation from which the soul's entire pathology unfolds. The positive kauchaomai cluster (boasting in Christ, in weakness, in others) has no psychological equivalent — psychology does not recognise the redemption of pride through re-anchoring in a transcendent referent.</i>
Convergence Points	<i>(1) Both recognise the distinction between healthy self-regard and destructive grandiosity (authentic vs. hubristic pride; kauchaomai vs. hyperephania). (2) Both identify cognitive distortion as central to pride (Obad 3; Dunning-Kruger). (3) Both document pride's incompatibility with empathy and other-orientation (1Cor 13:4; narcissism-empathy research). (4) Both recognise the physiological signature (postural expansion — Tracy et al.; biblical "high eyes", "haughty neck").</i>
Divergence Points	<i>Scripture grounds pride's pathology in its relational consequence with God (Jas 4:6 — divine opposition) — psychology has no equivalent. The solution to pride in psychology is self-compassion and accurate self-assessment; in scripture it is crucifixion of the self (Gal 6:14) and reception of grace (Jas 4:6 — grace to the humble). The eschatological dimension is absent from psychology: Isaiah's repeated refrain that all pride will be humbled and the Lord alone exalted (Isa 2:11,17) has no psychological analogue.</i>

SECTION 9 — RELATED WORDS (from the 181)

Intensifies / Generates	<i>Abomination (1) — pride of heart is its direct generative source (Pro 16:5); Anger (4) — pride challenged produces rage (Pro 13:10; Dan 5:20); Contempt (buz) — pride toward others; Deceit (39) — pride produces self-deception (Obad 3); Stubbornness (153) — proud soul resists correction; Wickedness (172) — pride as root of the moral pathology cluster.</i>
Opposes / Resolves	<i>Humility (80) — the direct antithesis (Pro 11:2; Jas 4:6); Repentance (135) — requires the humbling of pride; Shame (146) — functioning shame-faculty checks pride; Meekness (108) — the disposition God honours in place of pride; Wisdom (175) — "with the humble is wisdom" (Pro 11:2).</i>
Co-occurs With	<i>Abomination (1) — generative link (Pro 16:5); Shame (146) — pride and shame are in structural opposition and share the same soul faculty in inverted forms; Arrogance — overlapping vocabulary; Idolatry (83) — pride and idolatry share the same orientation (self in God's place); Anger (4) — co-occurs in the collapse of threatened pride.</i>
Registry Numbers	<i>1 (abomination), 4 (anger), 39 (deceit), 80 (humility), 83 (idolatry), 108 (meekness), 135 (repentance), 146 (shame), 153 (stubbornness), 172 (wickedness), 175 (wisdom)</i>

SECTION 10 — OPEN QUESTIONS & FLAGS

1. TRIAD COMPLETION — FRAMEWORK B FLAG: The three-card cluster (abomination, shame, pride) now forms a coherent structural unit in Framework B: — Abomination: the moral category that names what God opposes — Pride: the root soul-disposition that generates abomination — Shame: the soul's self-signal that registers abomination and checks pride These three are not merely related words — they describe a single dynamic system of the soul's moral-conscience faculty. A dedicated synthesis note should be written before moving to the next cluster. 2. INCURVATUS IN SE LINK: Augustine's 'incurvatus in se' (the soul curved inward on itself) and Luther's development of it as the definition of sin map precisely onto the biblical pride data. This is a significant patristic-exegetical convergence that should be incorporated into Framework B writing. Pride is not a sin — it is the condition of sin. All other sins are its expressions. 3. DUAL-REFERENT FLAG: Gaon applied to God (divine majesty, Exo 15:7; Isa 2:10) and to human arrogance (Pro 16:18; Eze 7:10) is a unique linguistic feature. The word does not change — the referent does. This suggests pride names a real capacity in the human soul (the capacity for self-exaltation) that is legitimate only when its object is God. This requires careful handling in Framework B — pride redeemed is not the elimination of the exaltation-impulse but its re-anchoring in the only legitimate referent. 4. CROSS-REFERENCES CONFIRMED: — Card 1 (Abomination): Pro 16:5 used in both cards; generative link confirmed — Card 146 (Shame): Phil 3:19 (glorying in shame) and 1Cor 13:4 (fusi■ vs agap■) connect the two cards at the structural level; the shame-faculty's disabling and the pride-faculty's inflation are co-occurring in the same soul-state 5. PHASE 2 FLAGS: (a) Root-sin analysis — pride as generative root for cross-analysis with wickedness (172), rebellion (132), stubbornness (153), idolatry (83); (b) Polarity analysis — dual-valence word with the most developed positive pole in the NT (kauchaomai cluster); (c) Neuroscience set — authentic vs. hubristic pride distinction maps onto Tracy & Robins taxonomy.